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MY POWAI

Volume No. 14 Issue No. 07 Mumbai March 2026

Your health report has a story.
Are you reading it right?

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vytalyou

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Dear Friends,

As we arrive at the final issue of this financial year, there's a palpable sense of transition in the air. The quiet cool of early mornings is slowly giving way to warmer days, and across Powai, homes and housing societies are preparing to burst into colour with the arrival of Holi.

It is that time of year when calendars seem especially full. Students are deep into revision with exams just around the corner, while families are already sketching out plans for the much-awaited summer vacations that follow.

The World Cup has made evenings livelier, and as it winds down, the Indian Premier League will soon take centre stage through May. Cricket enthusiasts have much to look forward to.

In this issue, our nutrition page features The Perimenopause Diet Guide, offering useful insights into managing this important phase of health. Our recipe section travels through time with the fascinating history of biryani. Alongside the story, you'll find a recipe to try in your own kitchen, perhaps during a relaxed weekend or as part of a family gathering. As always, our astrology page brings you the forecasts for the month ahead, offering a glimpse into what the stars may have in store as we step into a new season.

As one financial year ends and another begins, we hope this issue keeps you informed, engaged, and connected to the Powai community. Happy reading!

Warm regards,
Mahesh Kutty
(Editor)

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Animals & human beings coexist in harmony in a common home - Powai



D.P.K. Udas

A popular news clip recently covered the entry of a stray dog in an IIT Powai classroom. The lecture was in progress. Students were making notes. Dogesh bhai (as students call him) entered the class room and stood on the table.

The dog wasn't hassled nor were the students in the room. They are used to this peaceful co-existence. Some of the students recorded videos of Dogesh bhai attending the class and it has become viral on the internet. It is not that everyone gets a chance to attend lecture at IIT.

There is a case when one stray dog accompanies PhD student from hostel to class. He also comes back when lectures are over.

IIT has a policy of "No human animal conflict ". Powai campus has seen a crocodile walking on the lake side road. She went back to lakes after that. There was an incident when one African student walking on the road suddenly found leopard in front of him. He chose to be patient and leopard went back.

The colony houses routinely have presence of leopards on their stair-case. This normally happens in rainy season.

Even other IITs have forest attached to them. One in Chennai is nestled in the Guindy forest. It is a common thing to spot deer's, black bucks and monkeys on the campus. Forest department ensures their safety. Even Delhi campus has green cover. ISBT at Hyderabad has peacocks passing by.

Dogs normally identify with one particular place. Earlier Powai was full of hills and jungles. Subsequently, buildings have come up but dogs have not left and they are still around. Some societies have provided for one corner to feed these dogs.



Follow up with BMC is maintained to give them regularly rabies injection. The procedure for controlling their aggressiveness is done.

In addition to stray dogs there are lot many pet dogs in Powai. The place offers many grounds & parks to take them around. There are good Vets here for giving them treatment. Dog trainers are available. If you are going out of town then there are places where you can keep your pet dog for care.

However, everything is not very smooth. There are cases of dogs biting and dogs attacking in violent manner. But, these are very rare. Sometimes if there is any intruder in the area then lot of barking happens. It can also happen between 2 groups. This can disturb your sleep.

As such BMC carries out regular vaccination of dogs. They do not allow dogs to be relocated elsewhere. Dogs are provided with QR code around their neck. This helps in determining as to when they were vaccinated.

Another existence is of monkeys. There are cases of monkeys having entered houses and opened fridge and feasted.

Snakes are found in societies. However, they are never killed and trained person (SarpaMitra) is called they are nabbed and released at safer place.

The growing population of dogs within Powai has prompted many Gardens to put up board "If your dog poops you better scoop ".

(The author is long time resident of Powai. He takes up civic issues with the authorities. He has been instrumental in improving illumination in the area, zebra crossings , garbage removal etc.)



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What if your health checkup could tell your future?



Dr. Chirantan Bose



Dr. Preetesh Bhandari

At the heart of Vytalyou are two medical professionals who bring together deep clinical expertise and a shared vision for preventive health. Dr. Chirantan Bose (Dr. CB), a Molecular Oncologist, and Dr. Preetesh Bhandari (Dr. PB), a Radiologist, combine their experience across diagnostics and disease biology to look beyond traditional health check-ups and toward a more predictive approach to wellbeing. In this conversation with My Powai, they speak about the idea behind Vytalyou, the science of longevity intelligence, and why understanding how we age may become an important part of future healthcare.

My Powai (MP) What does Vytalyou stand for?

(Dr. CB) Vytalyou comes from the idea of "Vital You" because you matter. It is based on a simple belief. Health is not just about avoiding illness. It is about preserving your vitality. Your energy, mental clarity, strength and independence as the years go by. Instead of only looking at your age in numbers, we look at how your body is actually ageing. More importantly, we help you take steps early so you can guide that journey and stay at your best for longer.

(MP) What gap in traditional health check-ups made a Longevity Intelligence Report necessary?

(Dr. CB) Most traditional health check-ups are episodic and reactive. You do them once a year, glance at the numbers, and the main question usually is, "Is everything within range?" They often focus on individual values in isolation. One number for sugar, another for cholesterol, another for liver function. But rarely do they connect the dots across different systems in the body. Even when you've been doing tests for years, the long-term patterns are not always

vytalyou

tracked or explained in a meaningful way. And very often, the reports give you data without enough context about what it really means for your future health. The real gap is not the lack of data. It is the lack of context and integration.

A Longevity Intelligence Report brings everything together. It connects metabolic trends, cardiovascular risk, inflammatory markers, organ function and lifestyle risks into one unified picture that is easier to understand. So, the conversation shifts. Instead of just asking, "Is this normal?" the more important question becomes, "Where is this heading?" And that is what makes all the difference.

(MP) How reliable is biological age compared to conventional indicators?

(Dr. PB) Biological age is not meant to replace conventional health markers. In fact, it builds on them. Traditional health checks usually look at individual indicators like blood sugar, cholesterol or blood pressure. Each of these numbers tells you something important, but they are often looked at separately. Biological age brings all of this together into one bigger picture. It looks at things like vascular health, metabolic efficiency, inflammation levels, body composition and how resilient your organs are. Instead of being just a diagnostic snapshot, it acts more like a direction marker.

It helps answer a deeper question. Not just "Are my numbers normal?" but "Is my body ageing faster or slower than it should be?" That perspective is what makes biological age a meaningful and reliable indicator when it is interpreted alongside conventional markers.

(MP) Your Composite Longevity Score is proprietary. How do users trust it?

(Dr. PB) That's a fair question. Trust really comes from transparency. While the scoring method itself is proprietary, the inputs are completely visible. Users can clearly see what parameters are included, how each health domain contributes to the score, and where their strengths and risks lie. So the score is not meant to feel like a mysterious number coming out of a black box. It's actually a structured summary built from well-established medical markers. More importantly, the score is always explained in context. It comes with a clinical interpretation, a breakdown of different organ systems, and practical next steps that you can act on. In the end, trust doesn't come from hiding the method. It comes from helping people understand what the score means for them and what they can do about it.

(MP) Most common silent risks in high-performing professionals?

(Dr. CB) There's actually a pattern that shows up quite often among high performing professionals, even in people who seem perfectly healthy on the surface. Many have early signs of insulin resistance even though their blood sugar reports look normal. Some carry higher visceral fat despite having an acceptable BMI. Others show early signs of vascular stiffness, low grade chronic inflammation, or elevated stress markers. Poor or irregular sleep also quietly disrupts metabolism more than

contd on Pg 5

contd from Pg 4

most people realise. The interesting thing is that high performers are very good at optimising output. They push themselves to perform, deliver and stay ahead. But quite often, the body absorbs the hidden cost.

Everything may look fine on the outside and even in routine tests. But underneath, small changes may already be setting the direction for future health.

(MP) Can early detection genuinely slow decline? Any real examples?

(Dr. PB) Yes, especially when it comes to metabolic and vascular health, early detection can make a real difference. There have been many cases where people identified risks early and were able to turn things around. For example, HbA1c levels that were in the prediabetic range have been brought back to optimal levels within a few months. Visceral fat has been reduced significantly with the right kind of targeted interventions. Blood pressure has stabilised without needing stronger medication. Even fatty liver changes, including fairly advanced ones, have shown improvement when addressed in time.

The important thing to remember is that ageing itself is natural, but the speed at which the body declines can often be influenced. You can't turn back your chronological age. But you can slow down biological ageing, and early detection gives you that opportunity.

(MP) How does AI enhance interpretation without replacing clinical judgment?

(Dr. CB) AI is a powerful assistant, but it is still just that — an assistant. It helps make sense of large amounts of health data by spotting patterns, grouping risks together, connecting multiple parameters and comparing results over



time. Things that would normally take a lot of manual effort can be seen much more clearly and quickly with AI support. At the same time, AI does not diagnose on its own. It does not replace a doctor's clinical judgment, and it cannot fully understand the nuances of an individual's life, symptoms or context.

Clinical judgment remains at the centre of the process. AI simply strengthens it by drawing insights from much larger data sets and by helping create health projections that can be tracked over time. So instead of replacing doctors, AI helps them see the bigger picture more clearly, with proper clinical oversight guiding every decision.

(MP) How personalised are the intervention plans?

(Dr. CB) Very personalised. No two people age the same way, so the plans are designed around the individual, not just the report. We usually combine lifestyle changes with medical oversight so the approach is both practical and safe. On the lifestyle side, that could include a nutrition strategy suited to your body, the right kind of strength and metabolic training, better sleep habits and ways to manage stress more effectively. Alongside that, there is medical guidance as well. This includes monitoring specific risks, suggesting supplements where needed and adding medication only if it's truly required. Longevity is rarely about just lifestyle changes alone. And it's not only about medication either. The real impact comes from bringing both together in a thoughtful and intelligent way.

(MP) How do you ensure privacy and prevent misuse of biological data?

(Dr. PB) Privacy is taken very seriously because this kind of information is deeply personal. All data is stored in encrypted systems, and there are strict controls on who can access it. It isn't shared with any third parties without permission, and even internally, access is limited and carefully monitored. People also have control over who gets to see their reports. Nothing is shared unless they choose to share it. Longevity data can reveal a lot about a person's health and future risks, so it has to be handled with the same level of care and confidentiality as any medical record. That level of protection is built into the process from the start.

(MP) Do you see longevity intelligence becoming mainstream in India?

(Dr. CB) Yes, absolutely. It may take a little time, but the shift has already begun. For a long time, healthcare in India has largely been about treatment. People usually go to the doctor once something goes wrong. But that mindset is slowly changing toward prevention, especially in urban areas. With rising stress levels, increasing metabolic diseases and more professionals focusing on long term performance and wellbeing, people are starting to think ahead rather than just react. They want to understand what's happening inside their bodies before problems show up.

Right now, longevity intelligence may feel like a premium offering. But over time, it is likely to become a more structured part of preventive healthcare. Just like executive health checkups slowly became common, longevity profiling is likely to follow the same path. Healthcare is clearly moving in a new direction. Less about reacting to illness, and more about predicting risk, preventing problems and personalising care. That is where longevity intelligence naturally fits in.



From neighbours to family, Sunnyvale celebrates Formation Day



The residents of Sunnyvale, Kanakia Silicon Valley came together on February 14th to celebrate Formation Day and the choice of date naturally lent the occasion a special charm. Falling on Valentine's Day, the celebration embraced a red-and-white theme, transforming the building into a vibrant symbol of warmth and togetherness. From the lobby to each of the 24 floors, clusters of red and white balloons created a festive pathway that welcomed residents and visitors alike. The decorations reflected not just the spirit of Valentine's Day but also the sense of belonging that has steadily grown within the community.

One of the most eye-catching elements of the celebration was a beautiful rangoli designed by the residents. Carefully crafted and rich in colour, it stood as a testament to the enthusiasm and creativity within the society. Close by stood a unique and meaningful installation, a "family tree" that quickly became a point of interest. Photographs of residents receiving their apartment keys were displayed on it, symbolizing the roots of a community that had come together to create a shared home. Many residents paused to find their own photographs, reliving memories of the day they first stepped into Sunnyvale as homeowners.

The evening festivities began with a traditional touch as senior citizens of the society lit the ceremonial lamp, marking the formal start of the event. This was followed by an address from Chairman Ganesh Remani who spoke about the steady progress made since August 10th, the day the society was officially handed over by the builder. His update gave residents a sense of how far the community had come in a short span of time. To commemorate the milestone, a celebratory cake was cut jointly by the Chairman, Secretary and the treasurer, drawing warm applause from the gathering.

As the formalities concluded, the atmosphere gradually shifted into one of relaxed celebration. Residents had the opportunity to meet neighbours, exchange stories and strengthen bonds. The chaat counters opened early and quickly became a hub of activity, with people returning for second and third helpings well past dinner time. Conversations flowed easily and for many, it was a welcome chance to connect beyond hurried elevator greetings.

A popular attraction during the evening was the photo booth, where families and friends posed against festive backdrops. What made it special was the instant printing and framing of the photographs allowing residents to take home a tangible memory of the evening. The framed pictures soon became prized mementos of a day that celebrated both home and community.



Adding to the charm was a three-piece live band that performed a selection of old romantic songs, perfectly in tune with the Valentine's theme. The familiar melodies created a soothing backdrop and drew appreciative smiles from listeners across generations.

The highlight of the evening, however, was the performance by stand-up comedian Jeet Mody. With his quick wit and spontaneous humour, he had the audience in splits. His playful roasting of a few residents was received in good spirits, adding a personal touch to the entertainment and ensuring plenty of laughter throughout his act.



Dinner was served soon after, and more than 180 residents enjoyed the meal together, turning the gathering into a true community feast. A quiz contest added an element of excitement to the event, with winners receiving autographed bats signed by Shubman Gill. The prizes were sponsored by Tata Capital, whose support contributed to the success of the evening. The evening's proceedings were smoothly conducted by Deepti Girdhar, whose lively presence kept the audience engaged.

As the celebrations drew to a close, there was a shared feeling that the event had strengthened the bonds within the society. Residents left with smiles, photographs and warm memories, and with eager anticipation for the next occasion that would bring the Sunnyvale community together once again.

She manages everything… but who manages her money?

Every year, March 8th is celebrated loudly across the world. Flowers, messages, appreciation posts, and celebrations remind women how important they are to families and society. And rightly so.

Women are natural planners — they manage homes, careers, children, parents, emotions, and relationships. They stretch themselves endlessly for everyone they love.

But somewhere between responsibilities and expectations, one important area often gets postponed — **personal financial involvement.**

Not because women can't handle money. Not because they don't understand investments. But often because they feel there is no time, or someone else is already handling it.

Yet, true empowerment is not just emotional, social, or professional. It is financial confidence.

When women participate in financial planning, they don't just grow — they expand their life vision completely.

Quick Glance: Why Financial Planning Changes Everything

- Confidence in life decisions
- Security during uncertainties
- Equal voice in family money matters
- Freedom to make life choices
- Peace of mind about the future



Think of growth like a circle.

Many women already grow beautifully in family, career, and relationships — almost like 180 degrees of life mastery. But when financial awareness is added, life becomes **360 degrees complete.**

A financially aware woman does not need validation from outside. She feels secure, respected, and confident within.

And when a woman is financially strong:
Families become stable.
Children learn better money values.
Generations become stronger.
Financial planning is not about becoming money-obsessed.

It is about **reducing stress, increasing clarity, and living life with dignity and choice.**

This Women's Day, the real celebration is not just appreciation. It is participation.

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The Southern Tour to the Temples



When I learnt about the tour to South India, Tamil Nadu in particular, I was told that we would be visiting temples, palaces, and also go boating. I was delighted at the prospect of visiting places I had not seen before.

he tour was organised by a women's organisation comprising homemakers. The bookings were done a couple of months in advance for the flights as well as entrance tickets to the various locations. After meticulous planning, we boarded the flight to Trichy (Tiruchirappalli), an important airport whose walls were decorated with temple motifs and where models of temples were displayed.

A bus waited to take us to our comfortable hotel. On the way, the driver showed us scenic spots like the Kaveri River and a temple high on a hill. We freshened up and went for lunch at a nearby hotel named after a religious figure. After a short siesta, we planned to visit a temple. The temple was a huge place with scriptures from the Ramayana inscribed on its walls and a hall with a thousand pillars. It was a long walk to the sanctum, crowded with devotees who had come for darshan, which could be hectic for some. We then returned to our hotel, freshened up, had dinner at the hotel restaurant, and retired for the night, planning for the next day.

On the second day, we woke up early as we had to go to Chettinad. After breakfast and checking out of the hotel, we boarded our bus once the luggage was loaded. The journey began on a straight, clean highway and later continued through smaller lanes. We reached Chettinad after a couple of hours. We first visited a palace owned by a wealthy person of the town. It had stained glass windows at the entrance, Burmese pillars, and doors above which were paintings of people and peacocks. The tiles had different patterns and colours, and so did the ceilings. There was a courtyard signifying a large family living in the palace. Cane armchairs, benches, and different plants adorned the space. There was another building called the Heritage House, which had a writing chest, a kitchen with old-style pots and vessels, and wooden structures with their original polish intact. After lunch, we proceeded to Vellore, which has a huge temple with colourful carvings of gods and goddesses. Many devotees visit the temple daily for darshan. A cool breeze was blowing, as it was the coldest season in the month of January. We returned to the hotel happy but exhausted and retired for the day, dreaming of the next day's plan.

On the third day, we woke up early to go on a tour of Thanjavur. After breakfast, we set off. It was a long drive to the town, famous for its museum, palace, and temples. The museum had many statues of gods and goddesses carved beautifully, including Vishnu and Parvati in various forms. There were statues of Nataraja, both small and large, representing the divine dance incarnation, standing on a demon. All the statues dated back to the 10th and 11th centuries. There was another museum displaying scriptures, including the smallest and largest books, and texts of the Rig Veda and the Mahabharata in Sanskrit. A movie was shown featuring different scenic spots, an Air Force station, and factories.We then proceeded for boating in the backwaters of Thanjavur, surrounded by thousands of mangroves. Fishing nets were seen at selected spots. On the way, we had coconut water with fresh cream. We visited the local craft market, had dinner after the long drive, and retired for the night, thinking of yet another busy day.

On the fourth day, we woke up at different times. Some members went to the Matru Mandir, which accommodates very few people. It has a meditation centre where pin-drop silence is strictly observed. The rest had breakfast, which was a mixture of South Indian and Continental dishes as always, and then rested until the others returned. We boarded the bus to go to Pondicherry Beach, which was vast and clean. After coffee and snacks, we proceeded to Auroville, associated with Sri Aurobindo, who is known for his spiritualism. Maintaining silence, we went to see his picture and books written by him. We then visited the Matru Mandir premises again, which also included Aurobindo's ashram. As the area is large, we were taken around by bus. We ate at an Italian restaurant, boarded the bus again, and went for a long ride to our hotel in Auroville. Vendors were selling their goods at reasonable prices. Amidst the rains, we travelled by bus to Kanchipuram, known for its sarees. We had dinner and retired for the night, dreaming of the day out and shopping ahead.

On the fifth day, we woke up at the usual time. After breakfast, we proceeded to Kanchipuram. It was raining, and it took us about two hours to reach. We were awed to see the Golden Temple. The tickets were expensive, and members had to move quickly through the temple, accompanied by staff. Mobiles were deposited, and silence was to be observed as the closing time was nearing.

We boarded the bus and travelled a couple of hours for lunch. It was crowded, and meals were served on banana leaves — such an ecological tradition. We then went shopping at a saree shop that had several varieties of silk, cotton, and semi-silk sarees. Coffee was served to us. Members bought several sarees of different varieties and received discounts on their purchases. There was also a sale of silk sarees at the hotel. We returned to the hotel, freshened up for dinner, and retired for the night after packing our bags for the return journey the next day.

On the sixth day, we woke up as usual, packed our bags, and got ready to leave for Chennai Airport to return to Mumbai. We had a typical South Indian breakfast served on banana leaves, followed by coffee — the best in South India. The bus arrived, and we loaded our bags. It was raining — a January shower. We rushed into the bus to go to Mahabalipuram. One of the members bought gajras on the way to give everyone a South Indian look. We saw the stone-carved structures and took a group picture. The guide showed us the Rathas of Draupadi, Arjuna, Bhima, and Radha Krishna, carved out of single stones and centuries old.

We began our return journey, stopping for lunch on the way. We then resumed our journey to Chennai Airport, which was a couple of hours away. After completing the formalities, we did some last-minute purchases and had a refreshing hot beverage.

As the weather was cloudy, the flight was slightly bumpy. We were served meals on board, as the arrival time was late at night. We waved goodbye to our teammates and proceeded to our homes after a memorable journey down South.

- Preeti oka

From pressure to purpose: supporting teenagers through exam stress with the right feedback



Debika Chaudhuri

Thousands of teenagers preparing for competitive exams like JEE Main and NEET study under intense pressure because these exams represent security and success for their families. In this high-stress environment, feedback from adults plays a crucial role. When given thoughtfully, it can reduce stress, build confidence, and help students find meaning in their efforts rather than simply correcting mistakes.

1. Focus on Improvement, Not Judgment

Many teenagers see feedback as criticism. A low mock test score or red marks on a paper can feel like a judgment on their intelligence.

Instead of making general statements like, "You're weak in maths," focus on specific areas that can improve.

For example:

"I noticed you're losing marks in calculus because of small calculation errors. Let's practice slowing down during the last few questions."

This type of feedback shows that improvement is possible. It tells the student that the problem is not their ability, but a skill they can strengthen, it also shows them a path to fix the problem.

To encourage growth:

- Break large problems into smaller, manageable steps.
- Point out patterns in mistakes.
- Highlight progress, even if it is small.

When teenagers see that they are getting better over time, even slightly, they feel more hopeful and motivated.

2. Explain Why Their Effort Matters

After months of solving question papers and taking mock tests, preparation can start to feel mechanical and exhausting. Students may begin to wonder, "What is the point of all this?"

Your feedback should connect their daily effort to a larger purpose.

Instead of simply saying:

"Good job on scoring 85%."

You could say:

"You improved your accuracy this week. That shows your understanding is getting stronger. If you keep this up, your rank will improve steadily."

This helps them see how their effort leads to real results.

3. Make Sure They Feel Seen and Understood

Teenagers preparing for exams often hide their stress. They may feel anxious, tired, or afraid of disappointing their parents. If feedback focuses only on marks, they can start feeling like their worth depends entirely on performance.

Good feedback begins with observation and care.

For example:

"I noticed you seem more tired than usual. Are you sleeping enough?"

"I saw you skipped the mock test. Were you feeling overwhelmed?"

These questions show that you care about them as a person, not just as a student and helps build emotional safety and trust.



4. Separate the Person from the Performance

In competitive environments, students often think:

"If I score low, I am a failure."

It is important that your feedback does not strengthen this belief.

Instead of saying:

"You are careless."

Say: "There were three mistakes due to rushing. Let's work on managing your time better."

This way, you address the behavior. Teenagers need to know that one bad test does not define who they are.

5. Give Clear, Practical Next Steps

Feedback should always end with a clear plan.

For example:

- "Let's revise one chapter thoroughly before moving to the next."
- "After each mock test, write down three mistakes and why they happened."
- "Try studying in focused 45-minute sessions with short breaks."

Clear steps reduce anxiety. When students know what to do next, they feel more in control.

6. Acknowledge Their Emotions

Preparing for exams like JEE or NEET is emotionally demanding. It is normal for students to feel stressed or discouraged.

"It's normal to feel nervous before a test. Let's think about how you can manage that nervousness."

When emotions are accepted rather than criticized, students feel less alone.

Creating Meaning in a Competitive System

Nearly every teenager preparing for competitive exams wants to succeed. But more than marks, they want to feel capable, supported, and understood.

Feedback can provide that support when it:

- Encourages improvement instead of judgment.
- Explains the impact of their effort.
- Shows genuine care.
- Offers clear direction.

In a system that constantly measures performance, thoughtful feedback reminds teenagers that they are more than a rank or a percentile. It helps them grow into confident and resilient young adults.

And that may be the most important result of all.

(The author, Debika Chaudhuri, runs Elzix Foundation, an Educational Consultancy for the past twelve years. She has studied across three continents and has close to three decades of experience as an Executive Educator and Career Coach. She and her team help young people make important choices at critical junctures of their lives; develop self-confidence, if they don't know what to do; help develop their skills to make the right fit; create life-changing educational experiences and help them with college admissions. She may be reached at debikac@elzixfoundation.com)

Smokes, spills and suburbia – a letter to Powai



Chaarvi Athawale

Dear Powai,

I don't know when you began slipping away from us. I cannot pinpoint a date or a dramatic incident that marked the shift. There was no riot, no headline, no catastrophe that announced your decline. Instead, it has been a slow erosion, subtle enough to ignore, steady enough to normalise. You still look impressive from a distance. The towers still rise confidently. The lake still reflects the sky. But up close, something essential has weakened. The dignity that once defined you feels diluted.

Yesterday, my friend stepped out to walk the dog in one of the gardens of Powai, just as she has done for years. It was a beautiful moonlit night. The kind of serenity a quiet night always brings. Two men, drunk beyond awareness, stumbled in her direction and nearly fell on top of her. She had to move quickly, not out of courtesy, but to shield herself. There was no shock in her voice when she narrated it, only a tone of resignation. That resignation frightened me more than the incident itself. A woman adjusting her steps in her own neighbourhood because public gardens have quietly transformed into drinking grounds is not an anecdote, but a symptom of something meaner, something dirtier, something fatal.



Your streets once carried rhythm. Children learned to ride bicycles along those paths. Elderly couples counted evening laps with a sense of calmness. Conversations floated in the air, about exams, about promotions, about recipes, about life. Now the air carries the sour scent of alcohol in the afternoon. Benches meant for rest are no longer occupied by quiet couples, but by clusters I hesitate to call couples at all. Packs of youngsters gather in loud formation, bound less by connection and more by display. Cigarette smoke curls upward as bravado fills the air, peer pressure masquerading as personality, conformity dressed up as cool.

And we speak of it as though it were seasonal. "It happens everywhere," we shrug. We reroute our walks. We look away. We adapt. And in adapting, we permit.

A few streets away, I spotted two boys in crisp uniforms passing a small packet between them. Not a shred of nervousness in them. Boldly. Daylight wrapped around their audacity like a shield. Boundaries that once held weight, a sharp word from a neighbour, piercing eyes of a watchful adult, the quiet authority of the streets, are gone. Recklessness has been given free rein, seeping into veins of Powai like slow poison.

I remember mornings near Powai Lake when joggers moved with discipline and students stood straighter in their uniforms because belonging to this locality meant something. It symbolised aspiration, order, and a certain quiet pride. That pride has thinned. We have built higher walls and shinier facades, but we have allowed standards to loosen. Leadership in some of your buildings feels less like service and more like intimidation. Elected councillors and self-styled resident leaders patrol corridors like kings of their towers, using fists, threats, and fear as currency.

What troubles me most is not the presence of these problems, but the presence of acceptance. We whisper about certain buildings. We avoid certain roads at certain hours. We warn our children. We tell our parents to take different routes. We complain privately but hesitate publicly. We continue to praise the skyline while ignoring the sidewalks. We are polishing the surface while the foundation cracks.



You are not a brand, Powai. You are not merely a real estate investment or a picturesque sunset frame. You are where our parents grow older. You are where children learn their first lessons about right and wrong. You are the ground beneath daily life. When that ground feels unstable, it affects the essence of our locality. I do not want to remember you as something that "used to be better." I do not want the next generation to inherit nostalgia instead of neighbourhood. We have already allowed that loss. But you are still capable of dignity. One that demands vigilance, discomfort and voices that refuse to settle. These voices must be ours, unapologetic, loud, never backing down. Not just politicians, not just authorities, not just the "someone else" we always imagined. Ours.

I am not bidding you goodbye, Powai. Your streets are awake to our choices. Before erosion hardens into habit, before resignation cements into tradition, before memory becomes the only thing left to hand down, we must do more than watch. We must speak. We must intervene. We must stop letting comfort dictate our conscience. Wake up, not Powai alone, but every one of us who calls it home.

Walking your streets, still,
Chaarvi

Why skipping breakfast affects training performance in students

For a lot of students, mornings feel like a race. You wake up late, you rush to get ready, you maybe grab water, and you tell yourself you will eat later. If you have early practice or a workout before school, it can feel normal to train on an empty stomach. But the truth is, skipping breakfast can quietly lower your performance in ways that show up as low energy, poor focus, and slower recovery, even if you are training hard.

When you sleep, your body still uses energy to keep everything running. By the time you wake up, your "fuel tank" is already lower than it was the night before. Breakfast is what tops it up, especially with carbohydrates, which are the body's quickest source of energy during exercise. If you skip it and go straight into training, your body has less easily available fuel, so the workout feels harder sooner. You might feel like you are pushing more than usual for the same intensity, or like your legs are heavy earlier than they should be.

Skipping breakfast also affects focus and reaction time. Training is not just physical, it is also mental. You need to make decisions quickly, pay attention to instructions, and stay sharp. When you have not eaten, your blood sugar can dip, which can make you feel foggy, irritable, or slow. This is especially noticeable in sports that require quick thinking, coordination, and fast reactions. Even if you are physically capable, your brain might not be fully "online."

Over time, consistently training without breakfast can also affect strength gains and recovery. After a workout, your muscles need protein and energy to repair and get stronger. If you started your session underfueled, you are more likely to finish it feeling drained, and it becomes harder to eat enough later in the day to catch up. That can lead to a cycle where you are always slightly behind on fueling, which makes you feel tired more often and can make training improvements slower than they should be.

Injury risk is another reason breakfast matters for students who train early. When you are underfueled, your body can fatigue faster, and fatigue can change form and coordination. That is when small mistakes happen: you land awkwardly, you lose control of a movement, or you stop stabilizing properly. Skipping breakfast does not guarantee an injury, but it can increase the chance of training in a tired, less controlled state, especially if you are doing intense drills, running, or lifting.

The solution is not to force yourself to eat a huge meal at 6 a.m. The goal is to give your body something quick and easy that it can actually use. If you struggle to eat early, even a small snack helps. A banana, toast, a granola bar, yogurt, or a smoothie can be enough to improve energy and focus. If you have a bit more time, adding some protein can help you feel steadier, like milk, eggs, peanut butter, or Greek yogurt. The best breakfast is the one you can realistically repeat on busy mornings.

A helpful mindset shift is this: breakfast is part of training, not a separate "healthy habit." If you want your workouts to count, your body needs fuel to perform and adapt. For students juggling school, sports, and stress, eating something simple in the morning is one of the easiest ways to feel stronger, think clearer, and get more out of every session.

-Anushka Bahorey
Grade 11,
Singapore International School (Mumbai)



The silent workers of Powai



Girija Menon

Growth has hands, Hard work – not magic wands!

Powai is often described as one of the most happening suburbs of Mumbai.

From a distance, the skyline announces itself. One can never miss it and at the same time admire its beauty. Enter from the main road or look across the lake and the architecture rises in symmetry and ambition. The towers are tall. The gardens are manicured. The cafés glow late into the evening. Restaurants hum. Schools, hospitals, shopping arcades, wide roads, landscaped walkways. Everything in place. A description that sounds like pages from a "perfect place to live manual".

But not everything is perfect and that is true about everything in life, in fact about life itself.

It is easy to admire the transformation.

Because yes, Powai was once largely barren land. Much has been written and showcased about its rise. The design. The planning. The scale and makeover.

The price tags that now rival the height of the towers themselves, growing every day to kiss the sky.

But here's what we don't speak about enough.

The people who built it. I do not mean the developers but those hands behind those brand names in real estate.

Before the lights came on in those apartments, there were labourers standing under a harsher sun. Before the balconies held potted plants, there were hands that lifted cement, aligned steel, balanced on scaffolding, and worked against deadlines that often felt impossible. From foundation to finishing, it was their sweat that turned drawings into dwellings. Since it was sweat, there are no traces on files, magazines and tabloids that are put on the table to enable the sale
And the work did not end when the keys were handed over. Indeed, it never ends because if something so beautiful and expensive becomes your asset, it need maintenance.

The gardeners who keep the green spaces alive do not just trim hedges. They wake up before most to do what they are thee for. They nurture lawns that frame our evening walks and leisure strolls. They water the plants that soften the concrete and give the suburb its visual charm.

The road workers dig, fill, repair, and repeat. Through heat, through monsoon, through traffic that rarely pauses for them. We drive past, sometimes impatient, rarely aware that tomorrow's smoother commute depends on today's disruption.

Step into any of Powai's buzzing restaurants or shopping spaces. Behind every seamless experience is someone clearing tables, washing dishes, restocking shelves, standing through long shifts so others can sit and unwind.

And then there are the delivery partners. Yes, we complain about their speed on the road. We crib about traffic rules the break. Yet if dinner must arrive within a promised time, they are the ones racing against both clock and congestion to make that happen.

Each morning, from my window, I see the street sweepers at work. Their day begins before ours does. They collect what we discard. They sweep what we overlook. Cleanliness will always be debated. But it is also a shared responsibility. If they sweep and we litter, the imbalance is ours.
Security guards who stay alert through quiet nights. Housekeeping staff who ensure lobbies shine before residents descend. Drivers who wait patiently outside schools and offices. The invisible network that keeps Powai functioning long after the spotlight shifts elsewhere.

We celebrate architecture. We celebrate lifestyle. We celebrate growth. Its about time we celebrated those many who gave us reason to celebrate.

Growth has hands. Simple but deep enough for this thought to linger.

From the moment a structure's foundation is laid to the day families move in, these silent workers are the limbs that make it happen. Their names may not appear on plaques. Their stories may not trend. Yet their labour shapes the spaces where we build our lives across generations.

Powai's vibrancy rests on their quiet persistence.
Perhaps it is time we pause, notice, and offer something simple but overdue.
Acknowledgment.
Respect.
Gratitude.

Because the suburb we are proud of stands not only on concrete, but on human effort.

(Girija Menon, the author, enjoys her passion for writing. Her first love is poetry; an astute observer of the world around us, she loves writing down her thoughts in both poems and prose. LIFE THREADS is what she uses to weave this one-of-a-kind fabric that spans reams. She can be reached at – whisperingverses@gmail.com)



Dopamine Hijack

Navigating the world designed for addiction & brain-arrest (Part1)



Palak Sardana

The market forces are finally being called out by the distressed parents who have lost their children to their manipulative strategies. As I pen this article, Mark Zuckerberg is being summoned to represent and defend the allegations put out against his company Meta and the other social media corporations for deliberately designing & incorporating features into their platforms that hook and manipulate young minds, turning online engagement into addiction.

The plaintiff, a 20 year old, is contending that her early exposure to platforms like Instagram got her addicted to them. This adversely affected her mental and emotional well-being, hindered her development into adulthood, and intensified struggles with depression and suicidal thoughts. Most importantly, the lawsuit claims that this was done through deliberate design choices that made these platforms more addictive for children in order to boost profits.

Though social-media addiction, especially amongst youngsters, is too pronounced and omnipresent, the application of addictive strategies by marketing architects is nothing new. To increase sales and revenue, companies have often employed tactics to increase consumption & nothing serves their interest better than tapping into the compulsiveness of the human mind where the product or service is consumed impulsively and is not a rational, need-based choice.

Remember the tagline “no one can eat just one”; How is the marketer so sure that you won’t be able to stop at one? The product in this case serves no nutritional purpose except for catering to the tastebuds and having adverse long-term effect on health. The product’s recipe is refined to titillate the tastebuds; combination of high fat, salt, and carbohydrate, triggers the brain's pleasure center by releasing dopamine, the pleasure hormone also responsible for reinforcement, hence tricking the brain into wanting more. The quick dissolution of the product in the mouth and absence of fibre, fails to trigger fullness signals- misleading the brain into perceiving little or no caloric intake. And voila! The prophecy that you can’t stop at one is fulfilled.

The above two cases might look diverse with one manipulating the tastebuds and the other hi-jacking the attention via sight, sound & touch, the commonality however is that both are exploiting the brain’s dopamine-driven pleasure and reward circuitry.

Dopamine is a vital neurotransmitter that underpins a wide spectrum of functions essential to human well-being. It regulates mood, is responsible for motivation, reward and pleasure, and also influences learning & attention, movement & pain processing. Its equilibrium, like that of all neurotransmitters, is both delicate yet essential.



Fight With Addiction

The current environment which is engineered for constant stimulation & instant gratification can disrupt the dopamine balance easily. Social media usage, gaming, hyper-palatable foods, recreational drinks & drugs, instant delivery systems, all provoke surges in dopamine, creating transient sensations of euphoria. With repeated exposure, the nervous system adapts to these elevated levels, gradually dulling its responsiveness to ordinary & natural experiences. Over time, simple pleasures of everyday life like eating, socializing, hobbies, music, or intimacy lose their capacity to satisfy, giving rise to the condition called anhedonia, a diminished ability to feel pleasure.

As desensitization deepens, individuals require (like in the case of drug addicts) a higher level of stimulation merely to feel “normal,” fostering a cycle of dependency in pursuit of fleeting highs that do not last. In this state of dysregulation, dopamine’s life-enhancing role inverts, culminating in diminishing one’s capacity to find joy in the ordinary experiences of life.

Addictive behaviours and patterns of overconsumption often mimic the ill-effects of substance dependence. Neglect of responsibilities, lack of motivation, withdrawal-like states marked by irritability, mood swings, anxiety, and depression & loss of social connections are some commonly observed symptoms. Yet, unlike drug or alcohol addiction which is widely recognized and condemned, lack of awareness presents a challenge in identifying behavioural addictions which are often overlooked until they result as self-sabotage or self-harm.

Solutions are often pursued by trying to reshape the external environment; through government intervention, new laws and regulations, or by holding corporations accountable, as seen in lawsuits against major social media platforms. Unfortunately, the roots of the problem lie in systemic loopholes embedded within capitalist incentive structures, which obstructs the path that may lead to some meaningful or long-lasting change. In such systems, profit and growth are primary drivers. Even if one harmful practice is regulated, another often emerges in a different form because the underlying principles of maximizing engagement, consumption & revenue never change.

The intent is neither pessimism nor inaction, but to shift the focus towards where there’s greater control and autonomy which is at the personal level.

In the following edition, we shall explore strategies & tactics to empower the self against the looming threat of “drugified life”, ready and eager to take over.

Until then, take cognizance of your dopamine triggers.

(Palak Sardana is a Harvard certified wellness coach, a mental health counsellor, yoga teacher & founder of wellness venture, Tranquility Unlimited. Via these articles, her endeavour is to present non-invasive & practical models of wellness grounded in ancient wisdom and modern scientific research. She runs ongoing wellness classes. For joining or booking a personalized consultation/session, write to tranquilityunlimited@gmail.com)

The perimenopause diet guide



Nisha Singh

Of late most of my early forties lady patients come in with the same issues - " I am tired all the time", "I am doing everything, diet & exercise, still the weight doesn't move", " I am not able to sleep at night despite being tired", " I am feeling anxious and forgetful", " My gut doesn't feel the same, I am bloated and constipated."

With a slew of these complaints, comes the biggest whopper. People around them tell them one of two things - "you're imagining it/overthinking" or " it's just stress".

Well, the fact is neither are they imagining or overthinking it, nor is it just stress. What they are experiencing is Perimenopause.

What is perimenopause?
Perimenopause can be the 5–10 years of transition period before menopause. The ovarian function declines and hormones fluctuate wildly, often long before periods actually stop.
The good news - food and lifestyle choices can dramatically help you manage the symptoms.

Here's what's happening in the body.
During perimenopause, estrogen and progesterone aren't a simple and easy decline — they swing up and down unpredictably. Ovaries produce less hormones. Menstrual cycles may become irregular and erratic. This phase can begin from the mid thirties or for some even in their mid fifties. These hormonal shifts affect:
• metabolism • insulin sensitivity • sleep • mood • fat storage • muscle mass

Some of the most common symptoms include weight gain (especially around the abdomen), fatigue, brain fog, hot flashes, poor sleep, and increased cardiometabolic risk. So if your old diet suddenly "stopped working," it's not lack of discipline or will power — your body is changing. Which means your strategy has to change too.

1. Protein becomes mandatory
One of the biggest and actually silent shifts in perimenopause is muscle loss. Once you hit the 30s, one naturally loses almost 3–8% of muscle mass per decade. Lower estrogen levels accelerate this loss. When muscle mass drops, your body burns fewer calories at rest, so fat gain can happen more easily. Protein helps protect against that. Research shows higher protein intake improves satiety, preserves lean mass, and supports weight control — especially during midlife.
Yet many women (especially vegetarians) are eating less protein without realizing it.
Aim for: about 15 g -20 g in breakfast and snacks and 25 g to 30 g in main meals daily (sometimes more if active).
Do this: • Dal with curd instead of just rice • paneer/tofu with meals •Eggs, chicken, fish • Greek yogurt • sprouts, chana, rajma Think: protein at every meal, not just dinner.

2. Stable blood sugar equals stable hormones
During perimenopause, insulin resistance tends to increase. This means blood sugar spikes more easily — which worsens cravings, fatigue, belly fat, and mood swings. Large studies show diet quality directly affects chronic disease risk. Studies highlight poor diet - high refined carbs, low fiber, as a leading contributor to early mortality worldwide. Translation? White bread, sweets, and ultra-processed snacks hit harder now than they did at 25.



Simple swaps matter more than restriction:
• White rice → hand-pounded or brown rice/millets, opt for varieties like Kolam Or Kalanamak which have better GI. • juice → whole fruit • biscuits → nuts or chana • Sugary tea/coffee multiple times → limit or reduce sugar Pair carbohydrates with protein or fat. For example: fruit + nuts, roti + dal/legumes/eggs. This will slow the glucose spikes and keep energy steady.

3. Fiber is your ally
Here's something most people may not be aware of - fiber helps regulate estrogen. Excess estrogen gets metabolized in the gut. Adequate fiber supports this process and helps prevent hormonal imbalances. Fiber also feeds the guts good bacteria, which in turn influences inflammation, immunity, and even mood. Aim for 25–35 grams daily — far more than most people get.
Add more: • vegetables at two meals minimum • salads • seeds (flax, chia, melon, sunflower, pumpkin) • Legumes (chole, rajna, chana) • whole grains (ragi, barley, jowar, bajra, amaranth) • fruits with skin. If your plate is not colourful, then you are not consuming enough fiber.

4. Bone health starts now.
Estrogen protects bones. When it fluctuates, bone loss speeds up. By the time menopause hits, some women have already lost significant bone density. Guidelines from the World Health Organization emphasize adequate calcium, vitamin D, and resistance exercise to reduce osteoporosis risk.
Nutrition basics: • dairy or fortified alternatives • sesame (til), ragi, leafy greens • sunlight exposure • strength training
Food alone isn't enough — bones respond best to load-bearing exercise like walking, lifting weights, or yoga.

5. Sleep and stress management are important
If your sleep is compromised, no matter how "perfectly" you eat, it is not going to help. Sleep deprivation increases hunger hormones and cravings for high-calorie foods.Studies have found that shorter sleep duration was linked with increased calorie intake and weight gain.
Non-negotiables: • consistent sleep schedule • limit late caffeine • evening light as well as blue light reduction • gentle movement like walks or yoga • relaxation practices
Sometimes the best "diet change" is going to bed earlier.

6. Strength training better than more cardio
Many women respond to weight gain by doing more exercise and eating less. That can worsen muscle loss and slow metabolism even further. Resistance training helps maintain muscle, improves insulin sensitivity, and reduces belly fat. Even 2–3 sessions weekly makes a big difference.This doesn't mean heavy gym sessions only. Bodyweight exercises, resistance bands, yoga flows, or light weights all count.

Perimenopause is a transition that needs support. It's not a stage that one needs to fight. Accept and flow with it. Include diet and lifestyle changes. More protein. More fiber. Fewer refined foods. Better sleep. Regular movement. Strength training. The goal is to be consistent. As I always say - Balance. Nothing extreme — just small, repetitive, consistent, doable habits.

(The writer is a gold medalist in Food & Nutrition with more than 12 years experience. She manages various ailments through lifestyle and dietary modifications and specializes in weight loss & management. She practices at 102, Crystal Center, Raheja Vihar, Powai or Smile Craft, 23, Annapurna Industrial estate, Opp. CCD, Ghatkopar East. For appointments: 022 2857 6537 Email: singhnisha@gmail.com)

Biryani: A love story layered in time



Sherry Bhatnagar

There are dishes you eat. And then there is biryani — a dish you experience. A food that softens your heart.

The moment the lid is lifted and steam escapes in fragrant waves of saffron, basmati, caramelised onions, and slow-cooked spices… something ancient stirs within us. Maybe it's the way the whole house fills with fragrance before it's even served.

Or maybe it's the way everyone suddenly appears in the kitchen asking, "Ho gayi kya?"

Biryani is not just a dish. It's Sunday comfort. It's celebration. It's togetherness in one pot. But where did this beloved dish begin?

The story of biryani is as layered as the dish itself. Its name is believed to come from Persian words — birinj (rice) and birian (fried before cooking). When Persian travellers — and later the Mughals — arrived in India, they introduced fragrant rice dishes that gradually embraced Indian spices and flavours. A well-loved legend credits Mumtaz Mahal with inspiring a nourishing rice-and-meat meal for soldiers, and under Shah Jahan, royal kitchens refined it into a culinary treasure. Yet its true magic unfolded when it journeyed beyond palace walls and found a place in everyday homes.As biryani travelled across India, it picked up local flavours — and a little bit of emotion from every region. The kitchens of the Nizams of Hyderabad perfected the dum style — layering raw marinated meat with rice and sealing it to cook slowly creating bold, spicy, unforgettable Hyderabadi Dum Biryani.

In the era of Wajid Ali Shah, Lucknow embraced subtlety. Here, biryani became poetry — lightly spiced, delicately perfumed, and impeccably balanced.

When Wajid Ali Shah was exiled to Kolkata, economic realities led to the inclusion of potatoes. What began as necessity evolved into distinction. Today, the golden aloo is not compromise — it is identity.

From Malabar's coastal elegance to Sindh's robust expression, biryani has worn many crowns and every family proudly claims, "Our biryani is the best." And honestly? They're all right.
Do you really know what 's the real secret of the best biryani…it's Patience.
True biryani is slow. The pot is sealed. The flame is lowered. And everyone waits.

That waiting is part of the experience

Did you know traditional biryani was sealed with dough to trap steam — a slow-cooking technique called dum? Some old recipes were even perfumed with rose water or kewra, adding a delicate royal touch. With over 20 regional variations across India, biryani has evolved beautifully through time.

From grand weddings to simple Sunday lunches, biryani travels in tiffins, reaches neighbours, and brings families together. Born in royal kitchens yet forever at home in ours, it remains a timeless symbol of warmth and celebration.

Because at its heart, biryani is simple: Good rice. Good spices. Time…And people to share it with. And maybe that's why it never goes out of style.

Now, from nostalgia to cooking let's make the heart of every biryani: the Masala:

TAKE 2 tbsp coriander seeds,1 tbsp cumin seeds,8–10 green cardamoms,5–6 cloves,2 black cardamoms,1 small piece cinnamon stick,1 tsp black peppercorns, 1 star anise,1 small piece mace (javitri),1 bay leaf,2–3 dried red chillies and ½ tsp fennel seeds. Gently dry roast the spices until fragrant, cool them, and grind into a fine powder. Stored in an airtight jar, this aromatic blend stays fresh for a month — and just 1½ to 2 teaspoons can transform a medium-sized biryani or pulao. For an extra flourish, add a pinch to warm ghee before layering; the fragrance will rise beautifully through every grain of rice.

Wash and soak basmati rice for 30 minutes, then boil it with salt and whole spices until just 70% cooked, keeping the grains firm. Marinate chicken or vegetables in thick curd, biryani masala, ginger-garlic paste, salt, and fried onions, and let it rest so the flavours deepen.

In a heavy pot, brown sliced onions in ghee or oil, add the marinated mixture, and cook until nearly done. Layer the partially cooked rice over it, finishing with fried onions, fresh herbs, saffron milk, and a little ghee. Seal, cook gently on dum, rest briefly, and open to a beautifully fragrant biryani.

As you lift the lid and breathe in its warmth, remember this tale — and perhaps remember me too.

(Sherry Bhatnagar is a passionate food storyteller with deep roots in Indian regional cuisine, the author writes where memory, migration, and the kitchen intersect. Having lived across cultures yet firmly anchored in Indian flavours, her work explores food not just as nourishment, but as identity, tradition, and lived experience—told with honesty, restraint, and quiet depth.)



March 2026



Richa Pathak

March brings gentle forward movement. The emotional heaviness of the past months begins to lift, and clarity starts replacing confusion. This is a month to act thoughtfully, rebuild confidence, and allow new beginnings to take shape slowly but steadily.

Aries (Mar 21 – Apr 19)
March brings calmer confidence. You're learning to respond wisely instead of reacting instantly. Career progress builds slowly but steadily. In relationships, soften your tone—understanding will strengthen bonds. **Lucky Color:** Bright Red **Lucky Day:** Tuesday **Remedy:** Offer water to the rising Sun for clarity and strength.

Taurus (Apr 20 – May 20)
Steady growth defines this month. Financial planning improves and practical decisions bring security. Emotionally, you seek reassurance—communicate openly rather than assuming others understand. **Lucky Color:** Emerald Green **Lucky Day:** Friday **Remedy:** Light a ghee lamp on Fridays to invite harmony and prosperity.

Gemini (May 21 – Jun 20)
Conversations open doors this month. A professional discussion may lead to opportunity. Avoid overloading your schedule—focus creates success. Clear thinking helps you avoid confusion. **Lucky Color:** Light Yellow **Lucky Day:** Wednesday **Remedy:** Keep a small green plant near your workspace for mental balance.

Cancer (Jun 21 – Jul 22)
Emotional strength grows quietly. Family matters begin to settle and financial discipline gives peace. Protect your sensitive energy and avoid unnecessary involvement in others' issues. **Lucky Color:** Silver White **Lucky Day:** Monday **Remedy:** Keep rock salt in your bedroom and change it weekly for cleansing.

Leo (Jul 23 – Aug 22)
Confidence returns naturally. Recognition is possible, especially in work or creative areas. Stay humble—grace enhances respect. Consistency brings better results than dramatic action. **Lucky Color:** Golden Amber **Lucky Day:** Sunday **Remedy:** Offer gratitude to the Sun daily to strengthen leadership energy.

Virgo (Aug 23 – Sep 22)
This month asks you to simplify routines. Health and work systems improve when you reduce perfectionism. Small practical changes create lasting results. Stay flexible. **Lucky Color:** Olive Green **Lucky Day:** Thursday **Remedy:** Add a pinch of turmeric to bathwater weekly for clarity and purification.



Libra (Sep 23 – Oct 22)
Relationships require balance and honesty. You may set healthy boundaries that actually strengthen connections. Professionally, negotiations move in your favor when you stay confident. **Lucky Color:** Soft Pink **Lucky Day:** Friday **Remedy:** Keep fresh flowers at home to maintain harmony.

Scorpio (Oct 23 – Nov 21)
Inner transformation continues. You release old doubts and feel stronger emotionally. Financial matters improve with disciplined decisions rather than risks. Trust your instincts but stay practical. **Lucky Color:** Deep Maroon **Lucky Day:** Tuesday **Remedy:** Burn a bay leaf with written worries to release heaviness.

Sagittarius (Nov 22 – Dec 21)
Motivation rises steadily. Plans related to travel, study, or expansion begin taking shape. Discipline is essential—enthusiasm alone won't sustain results. Guidance from a mentor helps. **Lucky Color:** Royal Blue **Lucky Day:** Thursday **Remedy:** Keep a yellow item near your study space for growth energy.

Capricorn (Dec 22 – Jan 19)
Responsibilities increase, but you handle them with maturity. Financial stability improves through structured planning. Emotionally, allow vulnerability—it deepens bonds. **Lucky Color:** Charcoal Grey **Lucky Day:** Saturday **Remedy:** Write weekly goals every Saturday to stay aligned.

Aquarius (Jan 20 – Feb 18)
New ideas and connections energize you. Innovative thinking benefits career growth. Balance mental activity with proper rest. Social appreciation boosts confidence. **Lucky Color:** Electric Blue **Lucky Day:** Wednesday **Remedy:** Place a bowl of clean water in the north direction for clarity.

Pisces (Feb 19 – Mar 20)
Your intuition is strong this month. Decisions made now influence the coming months positively. Financial caution is wise, but creative efforts may bring gains. Trust your inner voice. **Lucky Color:** Aqua Green **Lucky Day:** Friday **Remedy:** Apply sandalwood lightly for calm focus.

(Astrologer Richa Pathak masters the art of Astrology, Vastu & Numerology. In-person consultation with prior appointment can be done at 207, Lantana, Nahar Amrit Shakti, Chandivali, Powai. She also gives Virtual Consultation & can be reached @ 8452920640 & www.jyotishdham.com)